

Project Indiana

Navigation Synthesis

Digital Unity
2025.10.24

verizon

Project Indiana is an initiative to systematically identify user interface design problems. This project used the Heuristic evaluation framework to gather and structure data.

Overview

Sample Data
Key Takeaways

Sample Data

Interface

- My Verizon app
 - My Verizon website
-

User Groups

- Authenticated customers
 - Unauthenticated prospects
-

Patterns

- Global navigation (e.g., top and bottom navigation bar, web header and footer)
 - Menu types (e.g., Hamburger, overflow, submenu/dropdowns)
 - Navigation labels, icons, CTA buttons
 - Sticky/Persistent navigation
 - Breadcrumbs
-

Key Takeaways

1

Platform Issues

The web platform exhibited significantly more issues overall and was the only platform with a critical issue. In regards to issue types, the app platform contained the most visual and content errors, while the web platform had the highest number of experiential issues.

2

Major Patterns

The audit surfaced three major recurring patterns: page title inconsistencies and unconventional design patterns on the web experience, and unclear user actions on the app experience.

3

Critical Usability Issue (My Verizon Overview Cart)

The absence of primary navigation on the My Verizon Overview Cart view page creates a significant usability issue. This critical production flaw requires immediate attention to restore user orientation and navigation on a vital page.

4

Quick Wins

A number of issues were categorized as quick wins, allowing the team to pursue immediate user experience improvements. Additionally, ten of the found issues on MVA were resolved by the Pathfinder launch and require no further action.

Analysis

Data & Insights
Major Patterns
Considerations

Data & Insights

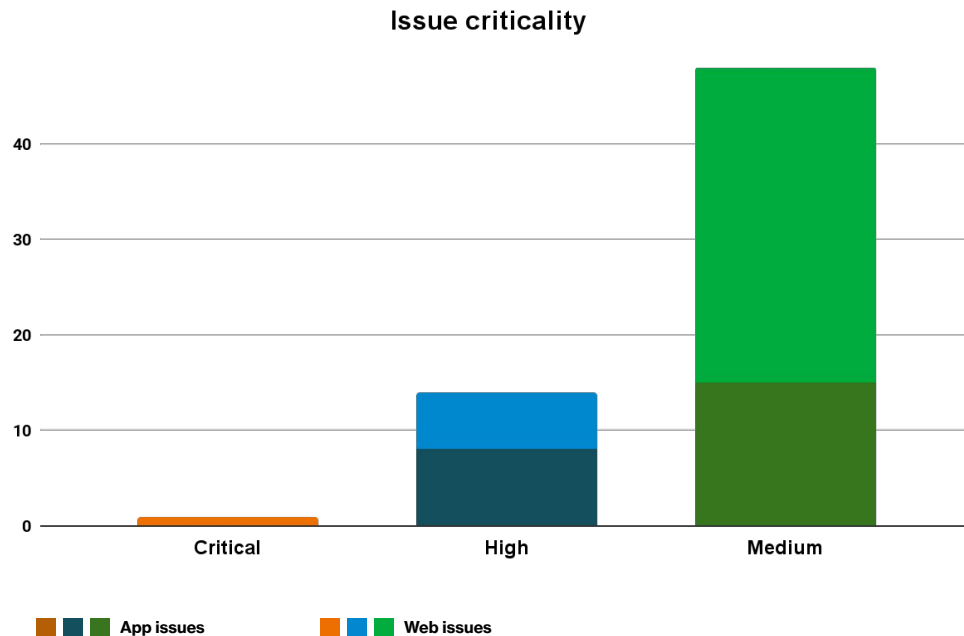
A data-driven overview of all identified issues, featuring graphs of their criticality ratings and derived insights.

All Issues

A total of **71 issues** were identified across the Verizon app and web platforms.

Insights

- The web platform had significantly more issues than app
- Web was the only platform that had a critical issue (though we could not replicate it)
- The majority of issues fall within the medium-to-high criticality range



Source:

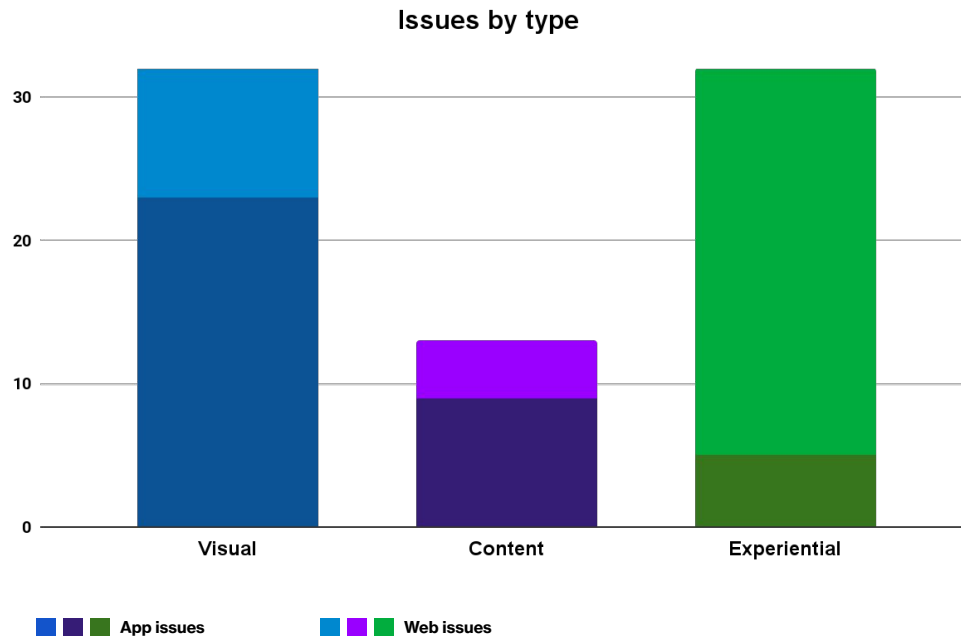
[Project Indiana App Navigation Spreadsheet](#)
[Project Indiana Web Navigation Spreadsheet](#)

Types of issues

Issues are divided across **3 pillars** or issue types.

Insights

- Total number of Visual and Experiential issues across app and web is on par with each other
- The app platform has the most visual issues
- The app platform has the most content issues
- The web platform has the most experiential issues



Source:

[Project Indiana App Navigation Spreadsheet](#)

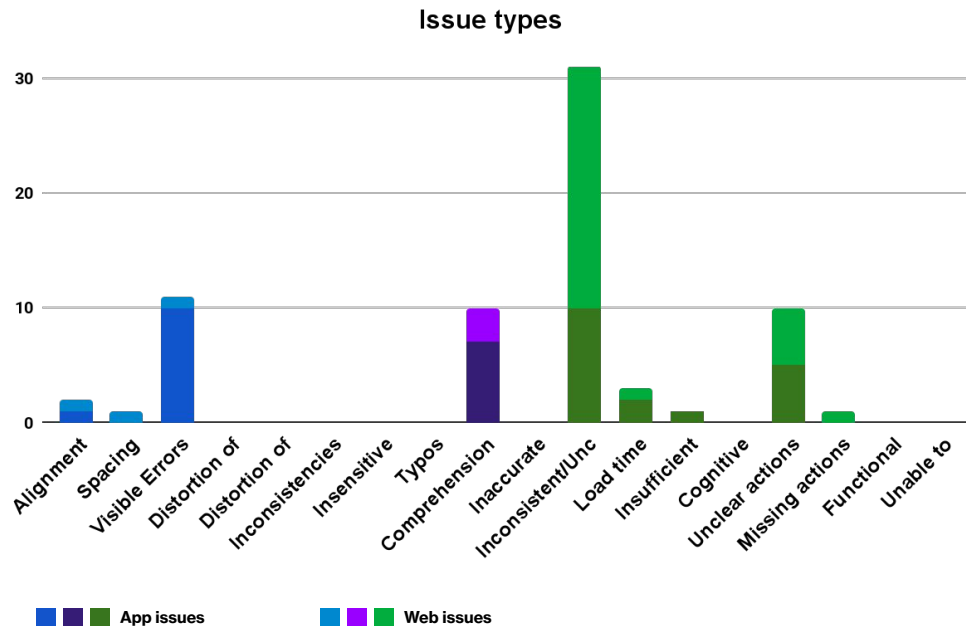
[Project Indiana Web Navigation Spreadsheet](#)

Issue pillars

Issues are subdivided within the **3 pillars**.

Insights

- Visible errors is the most prominent within the Visual pillar
- Comprehension is the only type found within the Content pillar
- Inconsistent/Unconventional UX is the most prominent type within the Experiential pillar



Source:
[Project Indiana App Navigation Spreadsheet](#)
[Project Indiana Web Navigation Spreadsheet](#)

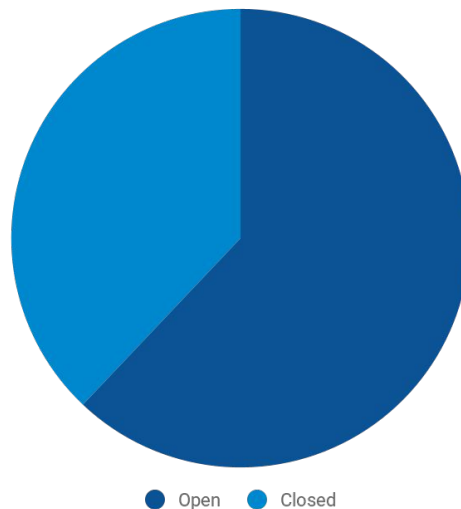
Types of issues

39% of MVA issues have been resolved.

Insights

- Total of 29 issues found on MVA
- 10 issues were resolved with the Pathfinder release.
- 1 defect was created and resolved
- Some issues were deemed low ROI and have not been logged as defects

MVA closed issues



Source:

[Project Indiana App Navigation Spreadsheet](#)
[Project Indiana Web Navigation Spreadsheet](#)

Major Patterns

Consistent issue themes found throughout the experience

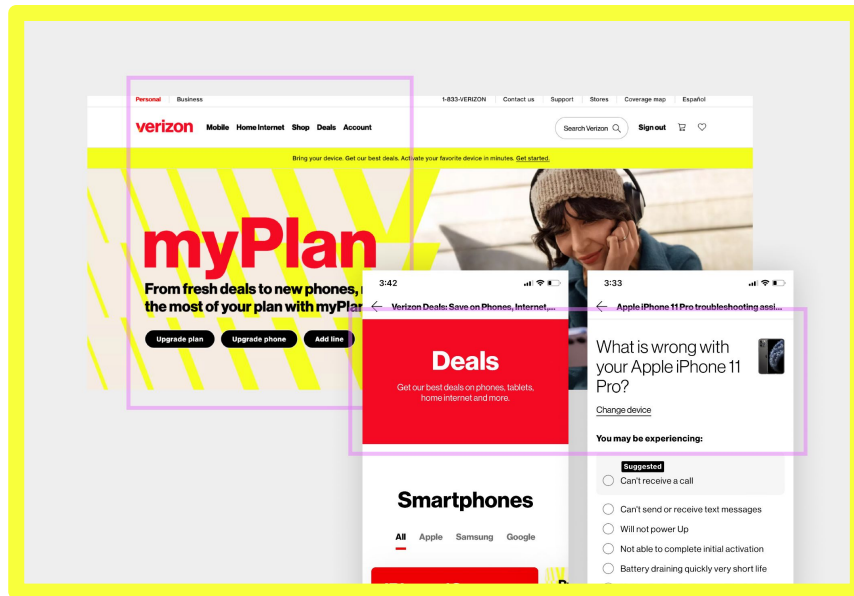
Page title errors and inconsistencies

Visual

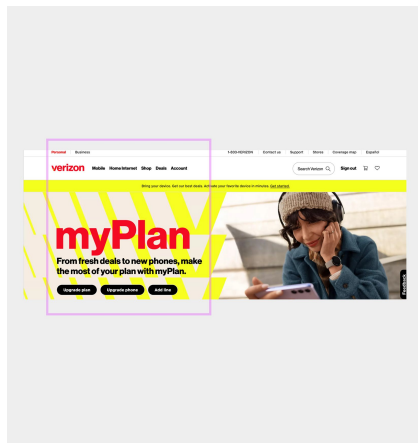
Content

We identified several page title inconsistencies across our app and web experiences, including missing or unclear titles, inconsistent placement, and varying visual treatments.

During evaluation, team members reported that these errors caused them difficulty understanding their location and navigating within the experience.

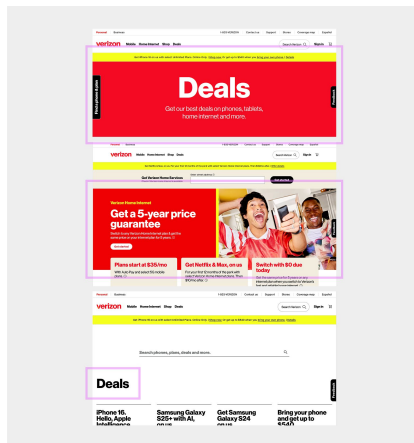


Examples of page title errors and inconsistencies



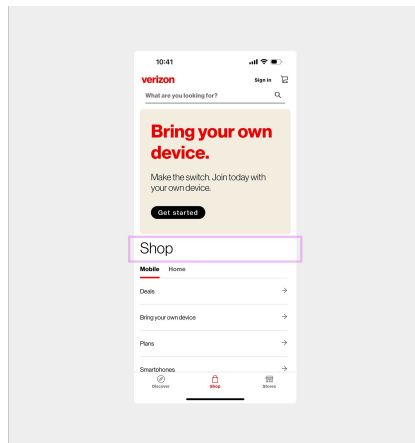
Misleading Page Title

The hero section on the landing page features 'myPlan' as a title, which functions as a marketing message rather than a true navigational page title for the rest of the content.



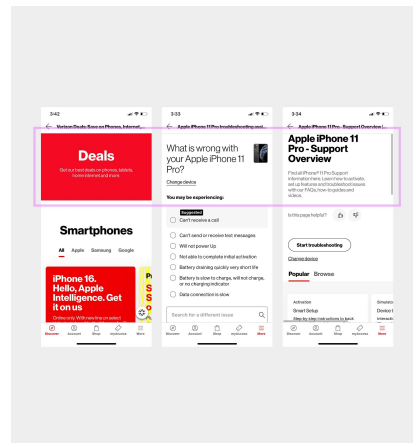
Inconsistent or Missing Page Titles

Page titles are either absent entirely or appear in varying locations with inconsistent typographic treatments.



Title Hidden by Advertisement

The "Shop" page title is positioned beneath an ad, which delays and potentially inhibits user orientation.



Inconsistent Typographic Treatment

Headline and subhead styles are inconsistent across the experience, varying in size, weight, alignment, and placement.

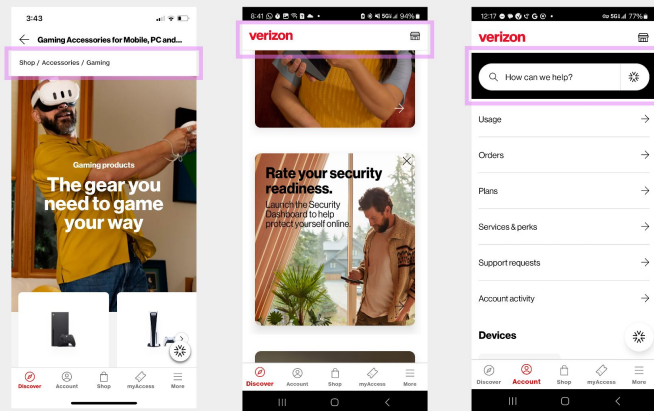
Unconventional patterns and design inconsistencies

Visual

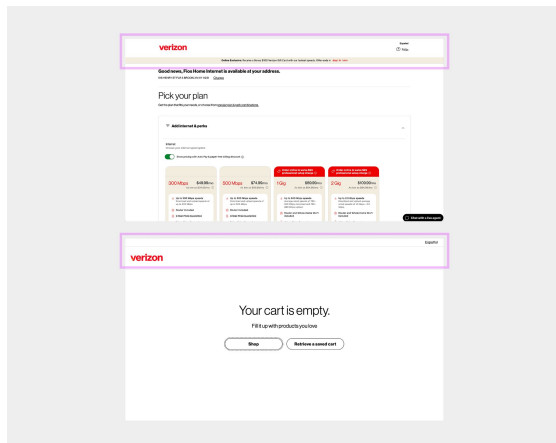
Exp.

The evaluation uncovered multiple design inconsistencies and unconventional patterns across both the web and app experiences.

The identified issues were generally rated medium to high, with no critical findings. Nevertheless, these breaks in consistency created noticeable friction in navigation, making it difficult for team members to orient themselves or locate key information.

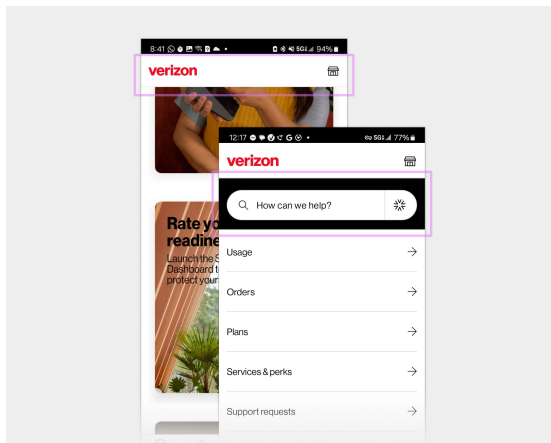


Examples of unconventional patterns and design inconsistencies



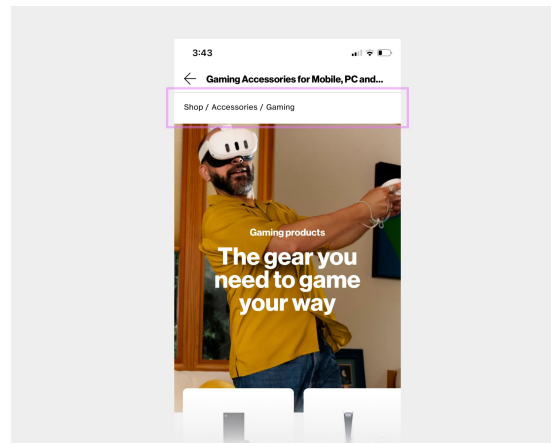
Missing Global Navigation

The primary global navigation L1s disappears in the lower funnel and on the cart page, hindering user orientation on critical pages.



Unreliable Sticky Search Bar Behavior

The sticky search bar is inconsistently applied. It appears on the "More" and "Account" screens but is missing from "Discover" and "Shop." Fixed with Pathfinder release. (Resolved with Pathfinder)



Inconsistent Breadcrumbs

The application of breadcrumbs is inconsistent across both the app and web experiences, and the style fails to adhere to Brand Central guidelines.

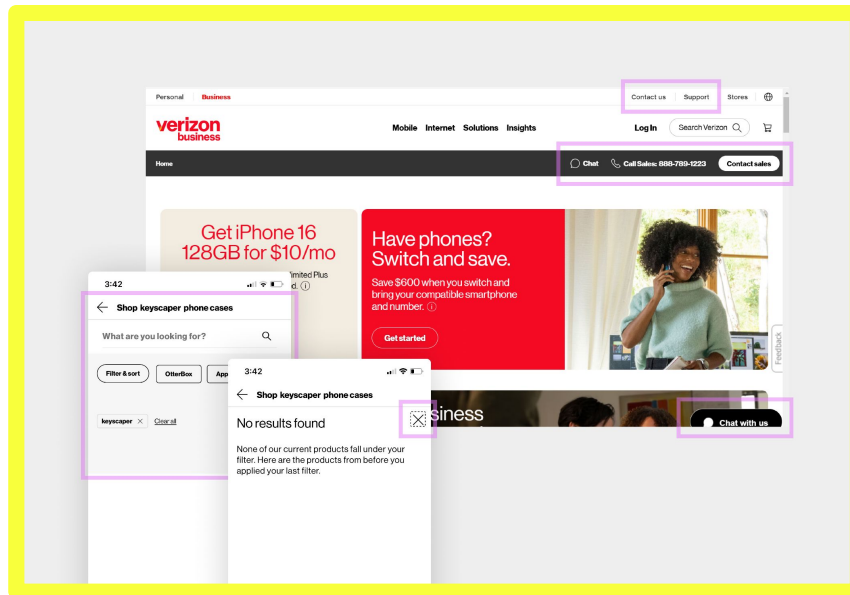
App Unclear actions

Exp.

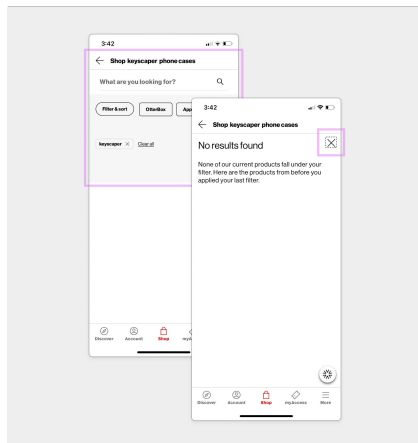
Content

We identified multiple instances of unclear actions across the app experience.

Team members noted difficulty both understanding the required steps in a flow and identifying which actions had already been successfully completed.

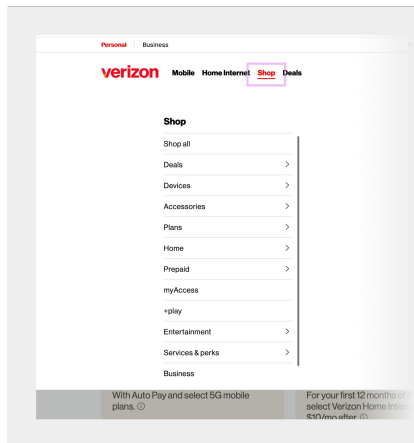


Examples of unclear actions



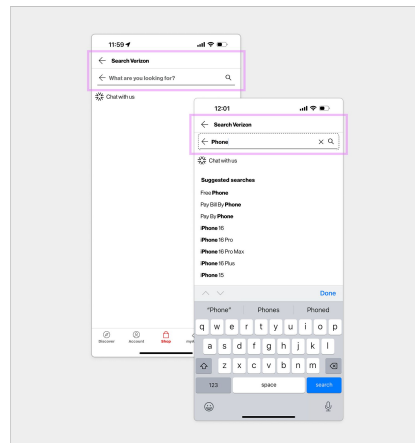
Misleading 'X' Icon Function

In the 'No results found' error state, the 'X' icon is misleading: it is intended to close the current view but unexpectedly navigates the user to the filters screen.



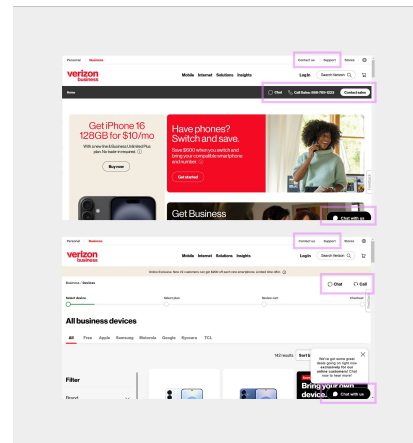
Missing Visual Cue for Dropdown

The 'Shop' primary nav item is the only L1 that features a dropdown menu, but it lacks a visual indicator to differentiate this interactive behavior from the other static L1s.



Redundant Back Arrow Icons

There are two stacked back arrows at the top of the screen, which conflict with one another and create navigational ambiguity regarding the intended destination and purpose of each icon.



Ambiguous Contact Paths

The interface features multiple chat and call CTAs alongside distinct "Support" and "Contact Us" links, which creates ambiguity about the purpose of each.

Meaningful Outliers

Issues identified in a single scenario that are highly critical or notably affected the overall experience

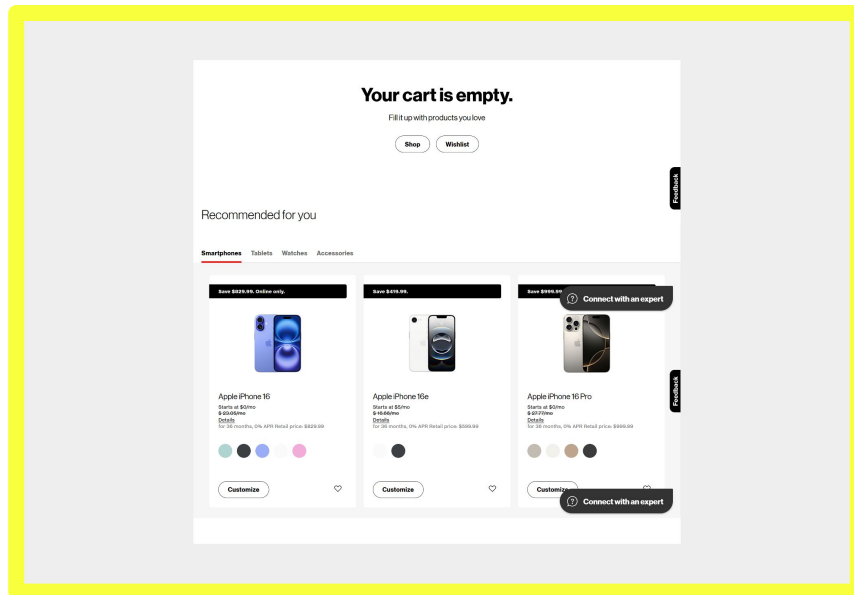
Primary navigation disappears in cart view

MVO experience

On the Verizon website, the absence of primary navigation on the cart view page presents a significant usability issue. Customers should always have access to navigation options, ensuring seamless browsing and interaction with the website. This is a critical prod issue that requires immediate attention.

While a simplified navigation structure could be explored for specific pages, data-driven decisions based on user testing are crucial before allowing essential navigational elements to remain absent.

This issue was not able to be reproduced.



Considerations

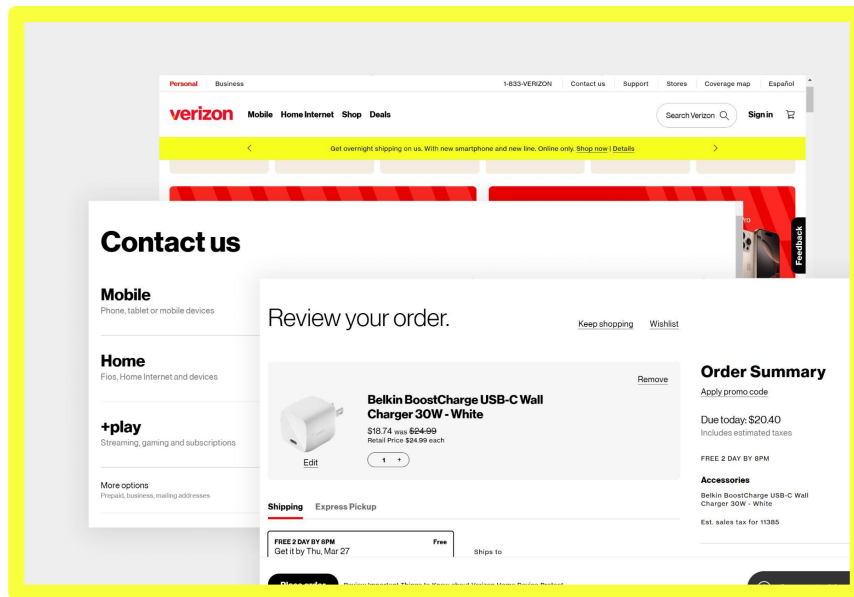
Issues that are either highly critical or represent low-effort opportunities for quick wins

Web

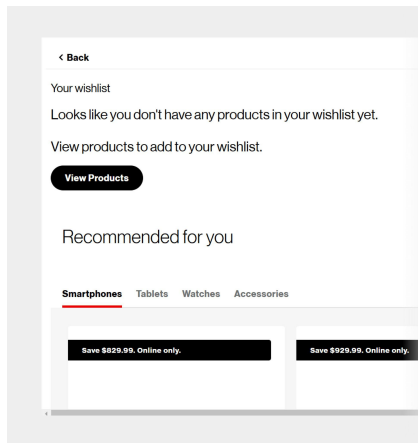
Inconsistent sticky navigation

The global navigation is sticky on some pages but not others, which creates an inconsistent user experience

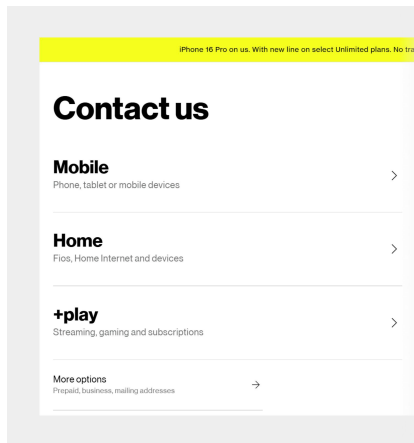
To ensure design consistency, consider making the navigation either sticky on all pages or on none.



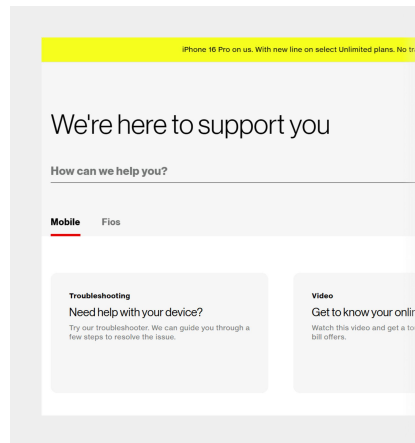
Examples of pages missing sticky nav



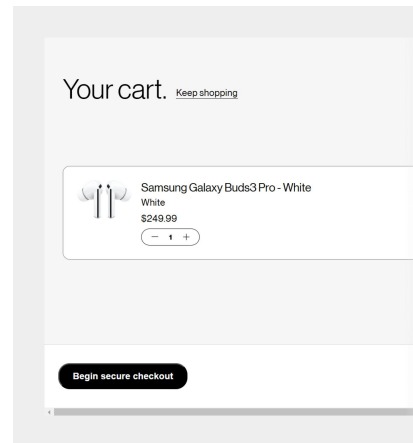
Wishlist Page



Contact Us Page



Support Page

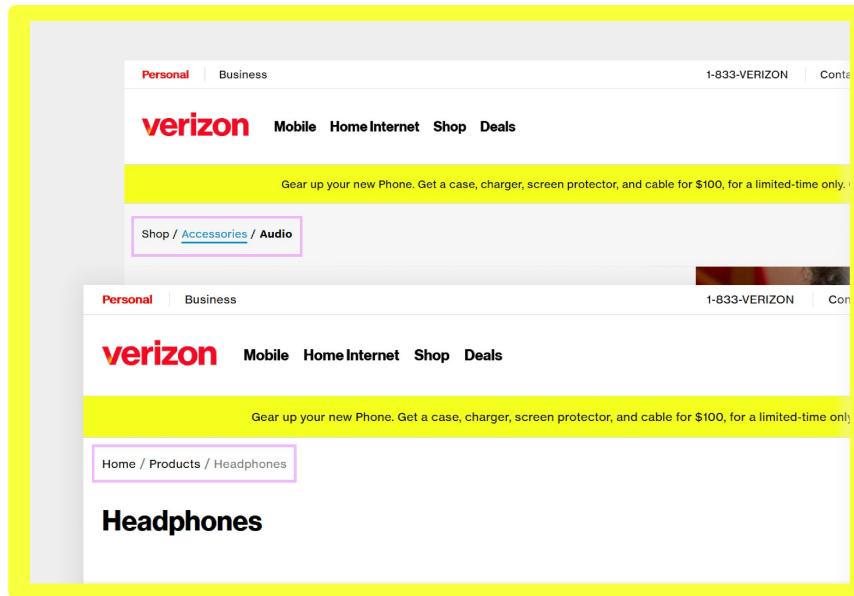


Shopping Cart Page

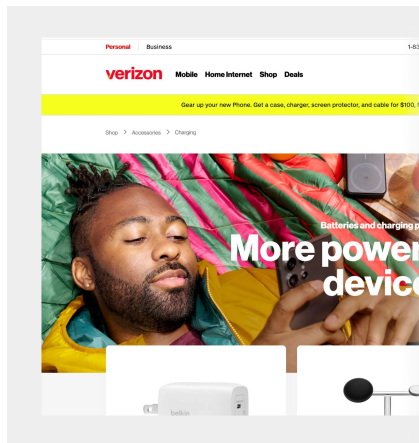
Inconsistent breadcrumb styling

Breadcrumbs are inconsistent across the web experience, deviating from the guidelines or not functioning properly.

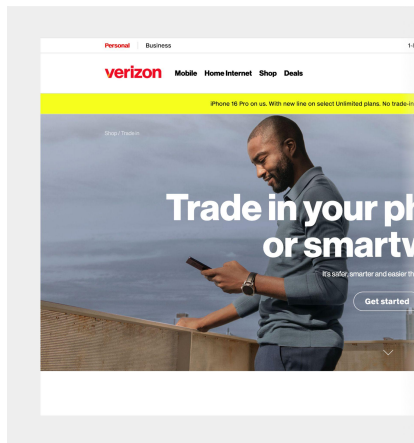
Consider aligning with guidelines to maintain a cohesive experience and ensure proper breadcrumb functionality.



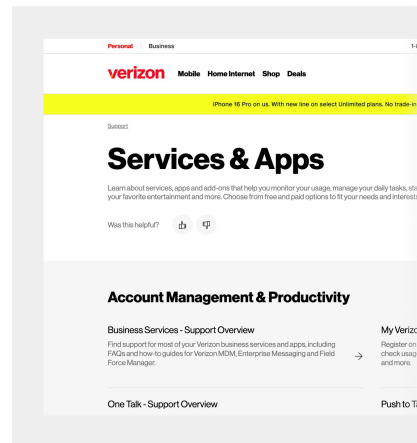
Examples of pages with breadcrumb inconsistencies



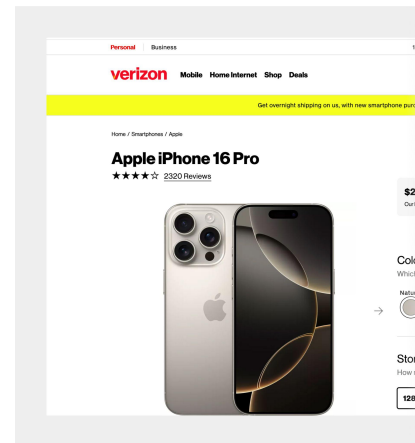
Charging accessories landing page



Trade in your device landing page



Services & Apps landing page

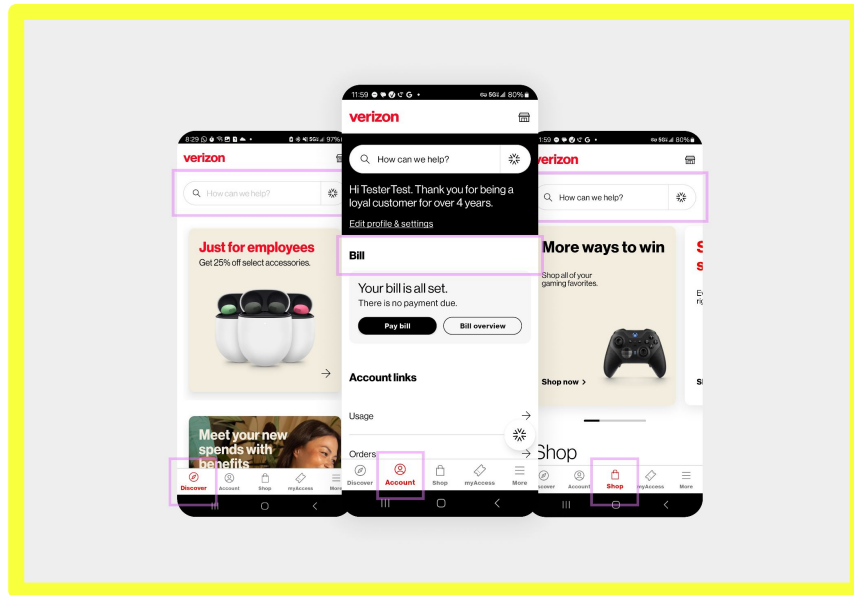


Apple device product detail page

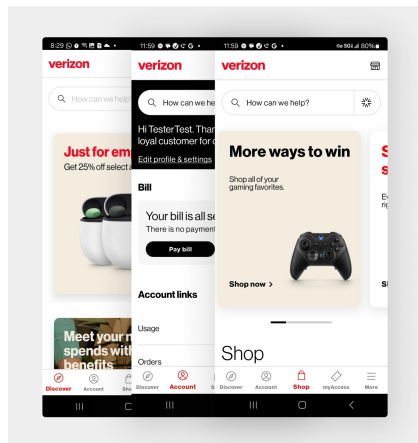
Most L1 pages are missing page titles

The absence of L1 page titles makes it challenging for customers to understand their current location within the experience.

Consider adding these titles consistently across the app to improve navigation and clarity.

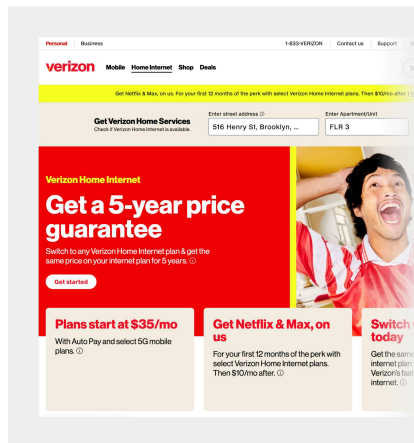


Examples of pages with missing titles



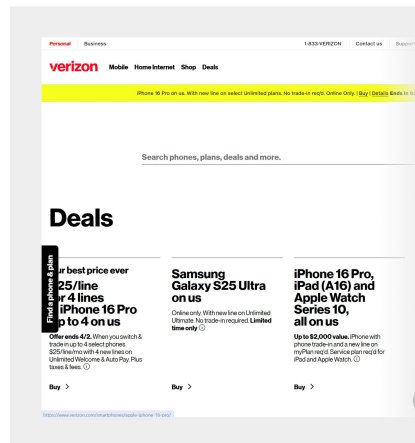
Most L1 pages in app

Most L1 pages in the app lack page titles, making it difficult for customers to understand their location within the experience.



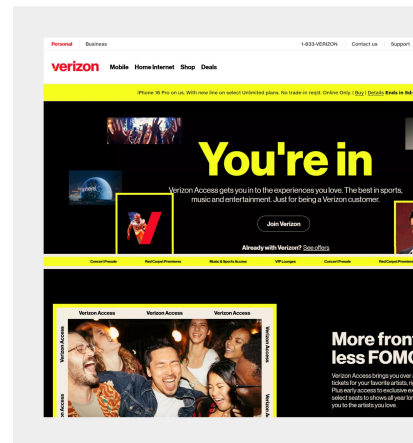
Home Internet Page

The home internet page lacks a clear and prominent title at the top, hindering navigation, despite the page title being featured in an eyebrow in promotional content.



Shop All page

The Shop All page lacks a title, while the “Deals” section header resembles a page title, potentially causing navigational confusion for customers.



myAccess Page

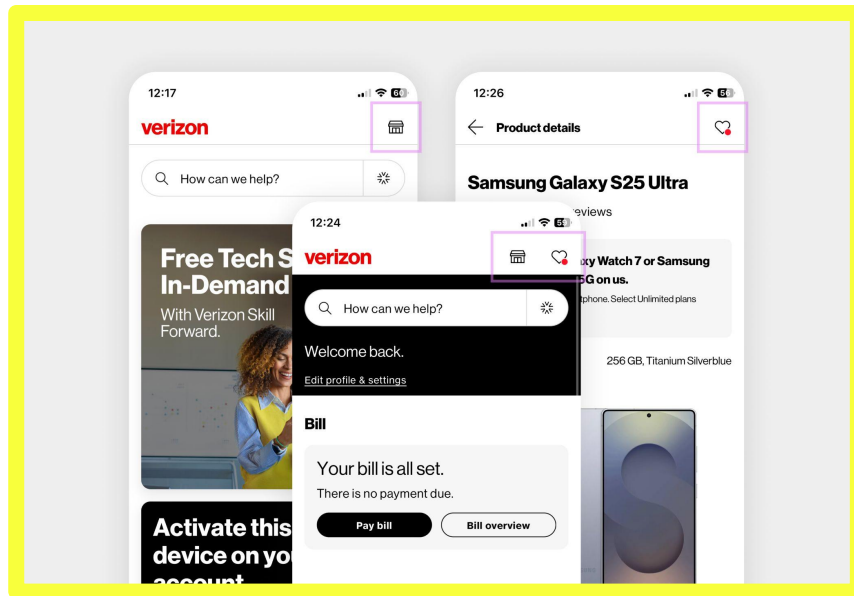
While the description copy at the top of the “MyAccess” page mentions “Verizon Access”, the formal title “All In” does not effectively orient customers to their current location, and the nomenclature is inconsistent between “Verizon Access” and “MyAccess”.

App

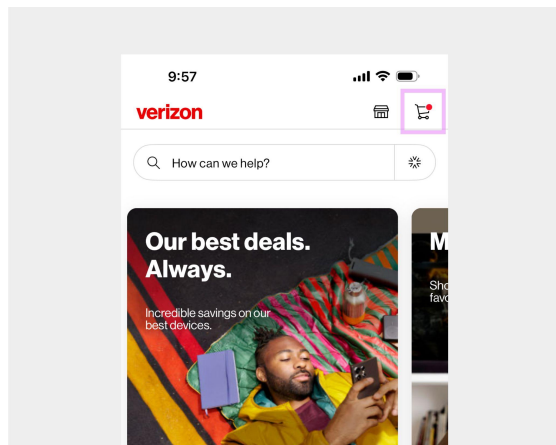
Top nav icons behave inconsistently due to guideline discrepancies and implementation

The inconsistent appearance and disappearance of top navigation icons stem from both the established guidelines and our inconsistent adherence to them.

Consider using a consistent set of icons for the top navigation bar across all screens. Our guidelines should recommend presenting these icons in a way that aids, rather than hinders, customer comprehension. Consistent adherence to these guidelines will ensure the icons function as intended.

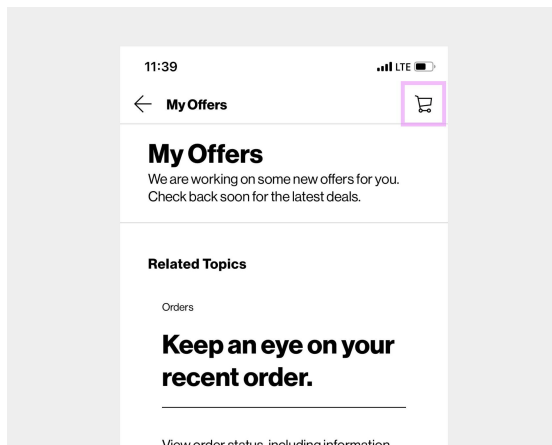


Examples of pages with inconsistent icon behavior



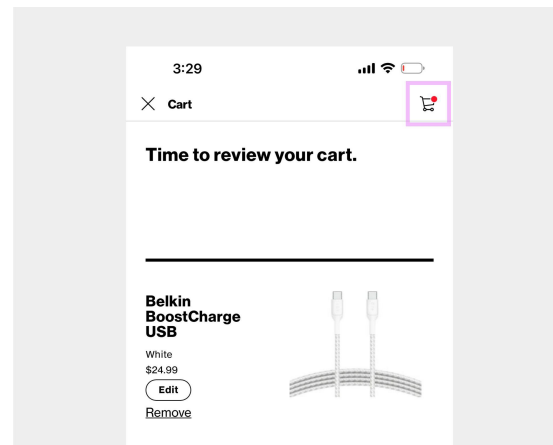
Items added to both Wishlist and Cart

If an item is added to the Wishlist, the Wishlist icon appears badged in the top navigation bar. But if an item is also added to the Cart, the Wishlist icon disappears and is replaced with the badged Cart icon.



Cart icon placements

Based on our current guidelines, the cart icon should not be present if it is not badged. In this scenario on the My Offers page, we have included the cart icon.



Cart appearing in Modals

The badged cart appears within Modals, which is inconsistent with our guidelines. In this case, the badged cart icon appears on the Cart screen itself, which is redundant.

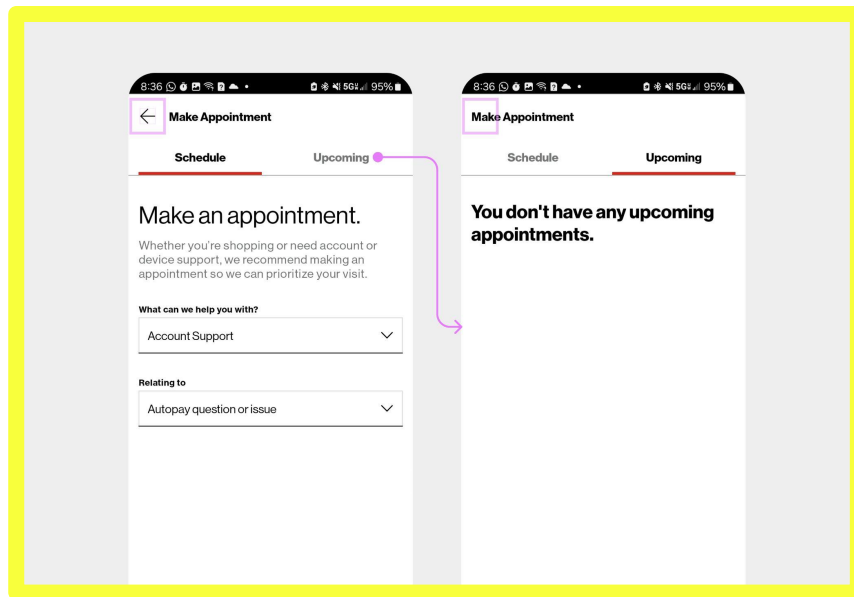
App

'Upcoming' tab on the Appointment screen results in a dead end.

When a customer navigates from the store icon to the Make Appointment screen and then to the 'Upcoming' tab, the header changes and the back arrow disappears, leading to a dead end.

Consider keeping the header consistent and always providing a clear way for customers to navigate back to avoid frustration.

A defect was submitted for this issue and it has been fixed.

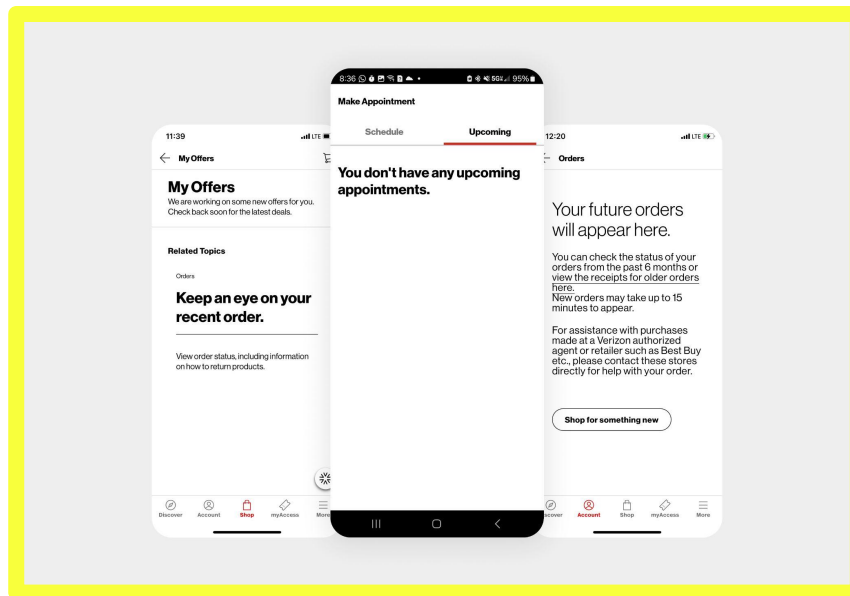


Tabs and menus contain null states

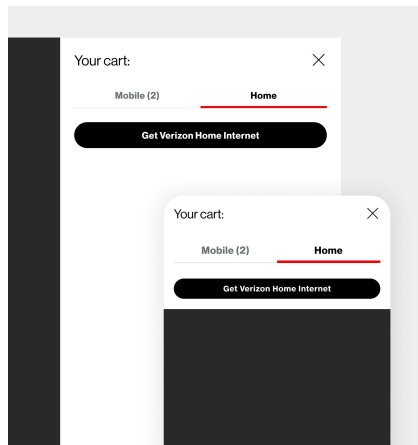
Several points in our app's user experience, such as certain tabs and menus, can lead to states where no content is available to display.

To align with the VDS guidelines, we should prioritize excluding empty states whenever possible.

In unavoidable situations requiring the display of an empty tab or menu, we should capitalize on the opportunity to provide an engaging experience. This can be achieved by showcasing relevant product suggestions, Verizon feature and service recommendations, or entry points that populate the empty state. Use clear UX copy and compelling CTAs for effective guidance.



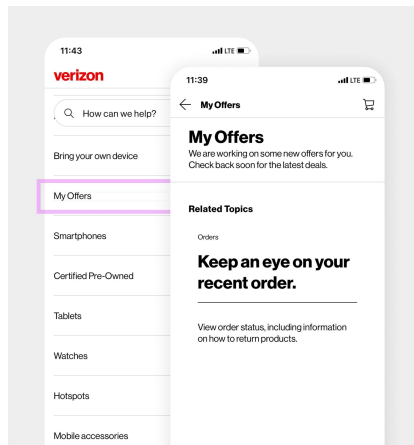
Additional instances of null states



Mobile Cart tab

Web & Mobile (In development)

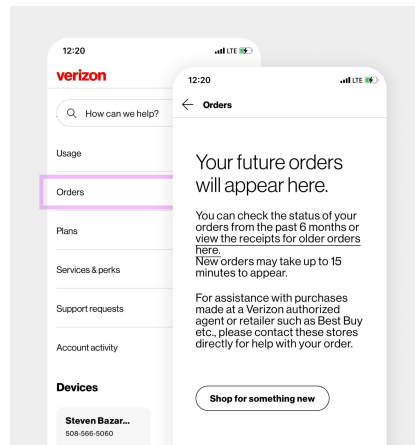
The CTA effectively guides customers to a solution for this empty state, but providing additional context above it would enhance customer understanding.



Menu: My Offers

Mobile

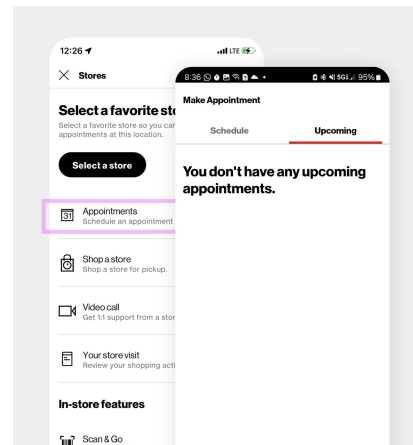
The related topics help customers navigate the experience and discover potentially interesting items, but a clear CTA for guiding customers appears to be missing.



Menu: Order Tracking

Mobile

This empty state effectively guides customers with context as well as CTAs, but we should confirm if the empty navigation links are necessary in this use case.



Appointments > Upcoming Tab

Mobile

This tab should be hidden when no appointments are scheduled. Customers without appointments should only see the “Schedule” tab.

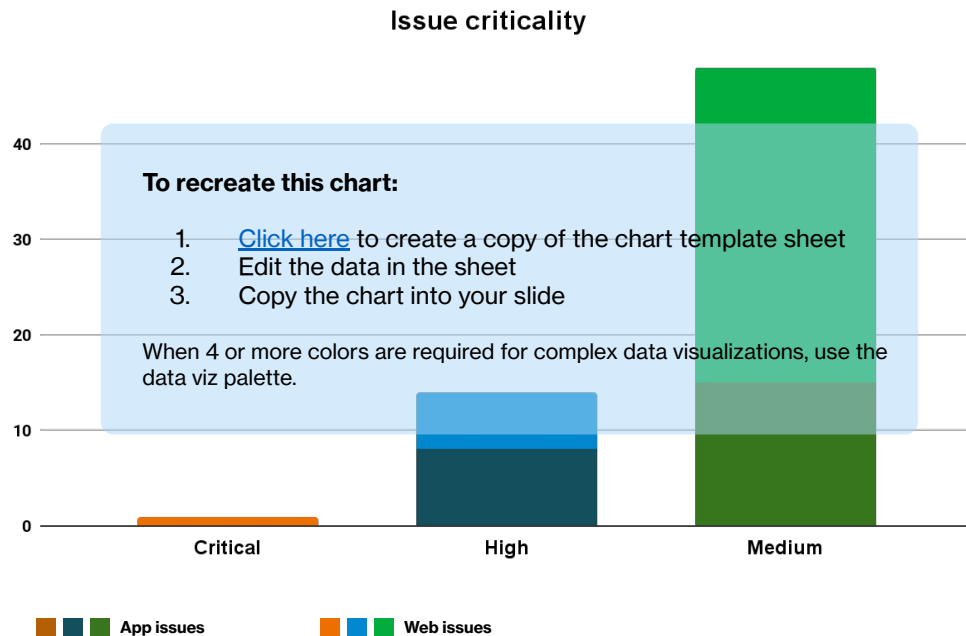


All Issues

A total of **63 issues** were identified across the Verizon app and web platforms.

Insights

- The web platform had significantly more issues than app
- Web was the only platform that had a critical issue (though difficult to replicate)
- The majority of issues fall within the medium-to-high criticality range



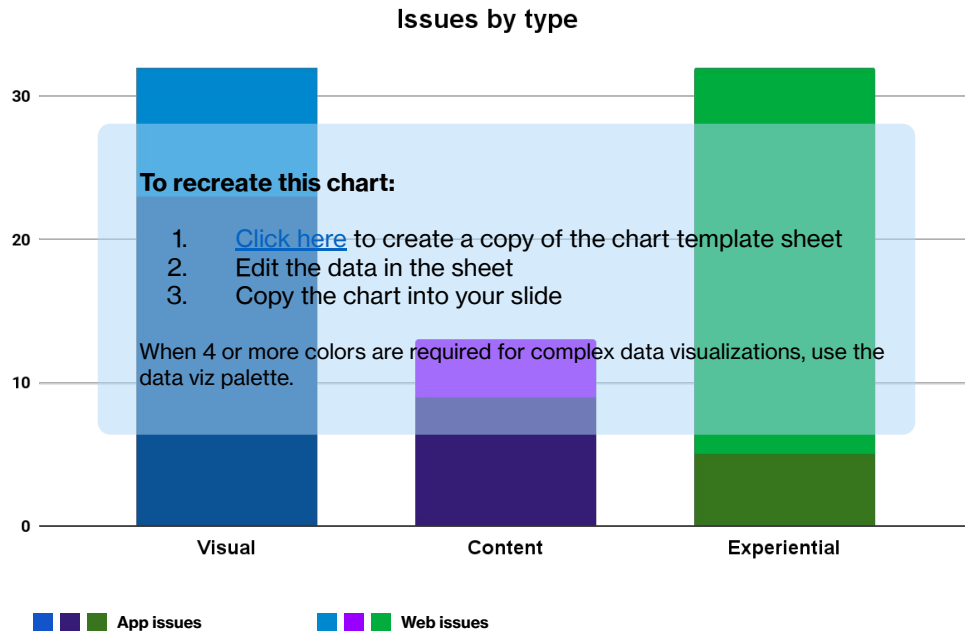
Source: Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet.

Types of issues

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Insights

- Total number of Visual and Experiential issues across app and web is on par with each other
- The app platform has the most visual issues
- The app platform has the most content issues
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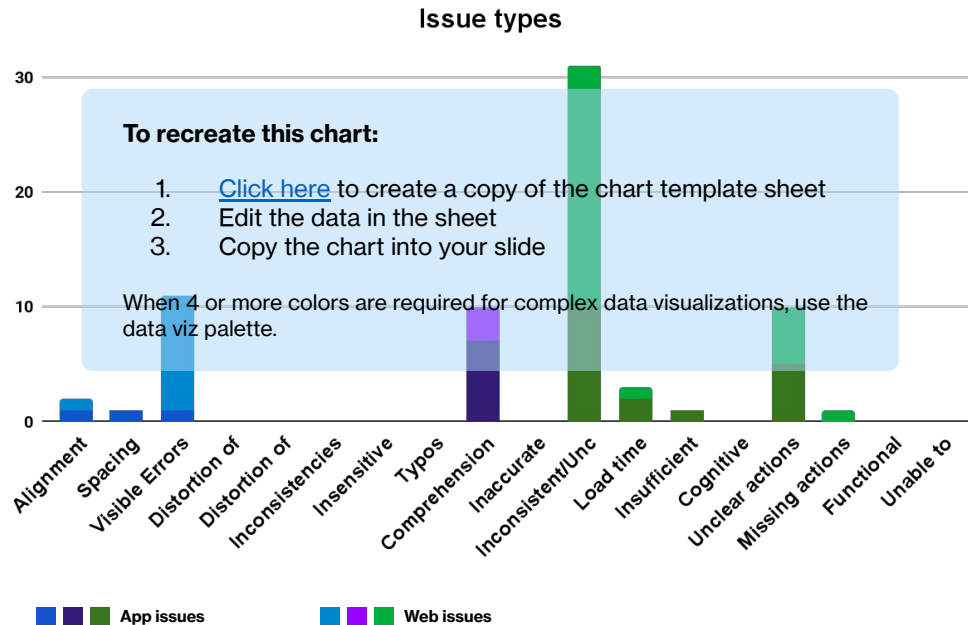
Source: Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet.

Bar chart

Issues are subdivided within the **3 pillars**.

Insights

- Visible errors is the most prominent within the Visual pillar
- Comprehension is the only type found within the Content pillar
- Inconsistent/Unconventional UX is the most prominent type within the Experiential pillar for both Web and App platforms.



Source: Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet.

Types of issues

39% of MVA issues have been resolved.

Insights

- Out of 29 issues 11 have been resolved, 10 from the Pathfinder release.
- Some issues were deemed low ROI and have not been logged as defects
- No issues have been logged for the web

Source: Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet.

MVA closed issues

